AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112B
Cultures II
Main – All Branches
Midterm Exam
2024-2025/Spring Semester
Date:8 April 2025
5:00 – 7:00

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 Hours**

INSTRUCTIONS

This Exam consists of TWO PARTS.

Part 1 contains 3 Short Answer Questions. You must choose TWO and fully answer the PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

Part 2 contains 2 Essay Questions. You must choose ONE of them and fully answer it i ESSAY FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

AOU EXAM

CamScanner

Part 1: Short Answer Questions
(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Choose TWO of the following questions and answer them in paragraph form. Each answer should be approximately 80-90 words, fully addressing all aspects of the question with supporting evidence from the course materials. Each paragraph must include a clear topic sentence, sufficient supporting details, and a concluding statement.

1. What is **iambic pentameter**, and why did Shakespeare frequently use it in his plays?
2. What is a **subplot**, and what purposes does the subplot serve in ***Twelfth Night***?
3. What is a **pseudonym**, and what were some of the specific social and cultural pressures that might have led women writers like Charlotte Brontë to use male pseudonyms in the 19th century?

Part 2: Essay Questions
(20 points)

Choose ONE of the essay prompts below and write a comprehensive response in essay format. Your essay should be around 350 words, covering all relevant aspects of the question and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essay with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. How does **cross-dressing** affect the characters and plot in Shakespeare's ***Twelfth Night***, and what does it show about gender roles and societal norms?

   Questions to consider:

   a. What is cross-dressing, and what are some reasons why people might do it?
   b. How does cross-dressing change how other characters in *Twelfth Night* treat Viola/Cesario?
   c. What problems or funny situations arise in the play because of Viola's cross-dressing?
   d. What does Viola's experience as Cesario say about how men and women were expected to act in Shakespeare's time?
   e. Does cross-dressing in *Twelfth Night* challenge or reinforce the traditional ideas about men and women?

CamScanner

5. Write a **character sketch of Jane** from **Charlotte Brönte's** novel ***Jane Eyre***, focusing on her **character development throughout the story**. Analyze how Jane evolves at different stages of her life and how these changes shape her personality and outlook.

Questions to consider:

a. How does Jane's early childhood at Gateshead Hall shape her initial character traits and values?

b. In what ways does Jane's experience at Lowood School contribute to her personal growth and resilience?

c. How does Jane's time at Thornfield Hall and her relationship with Mr. Rochester influence her emotional and intellectual development?

d. What changes does Jane undergo during her stay with the Rivers family at Moor House, and how do these changes affect her sense of self and independence?

e. How does Jane's return to Mr. Rochester and her final decisions reflect her matured character and the culmination of her personal journey?

AOU EGYPT

End of the Exam!

CamScanner